

Book Review by Dennis Gahm:

A Plain Account of Christian Perfection by John Wesley

- “impossibility of being half a Christian” (4)
 - So, what is Christian Perfectionism? If I am correct, it means that we can be perfect and completely sanctified in Christ in this lifetime.
 - Our goal in life is to become sanctified. Why do we sin? Why do we get angry? Why do we have habits that destroy? It is because there is unresolved guilt, or something that hasn’t been fully healed in us.
 - But Wesley believed that a mature Christian can reach the point of becoming fully sanctified and Perfect.
 - Jesus commands us, “Be perfect as your heavenly Father is perfect.” Why would he command this if it is impossible for us to be perfect?
 - Maybe this is the standard and we are to simply try to aim toward it, even though we may fall short?
 - **This is where the debate lies.**
 - Wesley says here, it is impossible to be “half a Christian.” Is a Christian always Perfect? Can he have flaws?
 - Romans 7 shows a man who carries with him a “body of death,” and does “what he does not want to do.” That surely is not a Perfect Christian? But is that the depiction of a man before he is saved – before he is a Perfect Christian or a Christian at all? Or is Romans 7 a depiction of a flawed Christian – the Christian that we are all too familiar with?